The Model Minority Stereotype and Help-Seeking in Asian American College Students

Bradley Allen

Department of Psychology, Willamette University

PSYC 497: Senior Research Internship

April 29, 2025

Abstract

Research suggests internalization of the model minority stereotype among Asian American college students is associated with self-esteem. However, the extent to which internalization of the MMS affects academic behavior is under explored. Using data sampled from 226 Asian American college students recruited through Prolific Panels, the present study explored pathways from the MMS as internalized stereotypes of hard work and innate intelligence and self-esteem as mediated by academic help-seeking. Consistent with hypotheses derived from research on academic help-seeking, the results indicated that internalization of a hard work stereotype was indirectly and positively associated with self-esteem through instrumental help-seeking, while internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype was marginally indirectly and negatively associated with self-esteem through executive help-seeking. Future studies should explore factors associated with academic achievement (e.g., grades, frequency of help-seeking) as outcomes to better understand the impact of internalization of the MMS on Asian American college students.

Keywords: model minority stereotype, academic help-seeking, self-esteem

The Model Minority Stereotype and Help-Seeking in Asian American College Students

> *"Give a man a fish and you feed him for a day; Teach him how to fish, and you feed him for a lifetime."*
>
> – Lao Tzu, *Chinese Proverb*

Lao Tzu's proverb is analogous to the psychological construct of academic help seeking. *Academic help-seeking* (AHS) is defined as a student's willingness to locate and use additional academic resources, and has been long associated with academic achievement (Ames & Lau, 1982; Karabenick & Knapp, 1988). To borrow from Tzu, to "give a man a fish" is the academic equivalent of giving a student an answer. In terms of AHS, this process is known as *executive help-seeking*, which is seeking an answer to reduce work (Karabenick, 2003; Nelson-Le Gall, 1981,1985). Similarly, "teaching a man to fish" is the AHS equivalent of *instrumental help-seeking*, which is seeking the minimum amount of help necessary to solve a problem. As the definitions indicate, executive help-seeking and instrumental help-seeking are differentially associated with effort.

For Asian Americans, effort is historically associated with a stereotype. In 1966, *The New York Times Magazine* (Petersen, 1966) and *U.S. News and World Report* ("Success Story", 1966) praised Japanese- and Chinese-Americans, respectively, for low crime rates within their communities, their ability to accrue wealth, and high academic achievement in contrast to other ethnic minorities. These articles are considered to have originated the Model Minority Stereotype (MMS) of Asian-Americans as having overcome racial discrimination through self-determination (Osajima, 2005; Suzuki, 2002; Walton & Truong, 2023). Evidence of the MMS is often seen in television and magazine portrayals of Asian-Americans as intrinsically intelligent, hardworking, and technologically proficient (Lee & Joo, 2005; Taylor & Stern, 1997).

Recently, internalization of the MMS has been examined as internalized stereotypes of hard work and innate intelligence. Research by Witkow et al. (2024) revealed that an internalized stereotype of hard work was indirectly and positively associated with self-esteem when mediated by grit. Similarly, they found that an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence was indirectly and negatively associated with self-esteem when mediated by a fixed mindset. An internalized stereotype of hard work was defined as achievement resulting from effort and predicted trait grit. Grit was defined as an individual's ability to pursue long-term goals despite setbacks (Duckworth et al., 2007). Witkow et al. defined an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence as achievement resulting from natural intelligence, and predicted a fixed mindset. A fixed mindset was defined as the belief that one's intelligence is unchangeable (Duckworth et al., 2007). The goal of the present paper is to explore the possibility that academic help-seeking, as a clear behavioral indicator reflecting one's approach to learning and achievement, similarly mediates the relationship between internalization of the MMS and self-esteem.

MMS and Help-seeking

In keeping with Witkow et al. (2024), internalization of the MMS will be explored as the internalization of a stereotype of hard work versus an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence. In an academic sense, internalization of a stereotype of hard work implies that the individual believes the stereotype of the model minotrity indicates that success is achieved through effort / hard work. By contrast, internalization of a stereotype of innate intelligence implies the stereotype of the model minority indicates that that setbacks result from insufficient intelligence. Students who face academic setbacks routinely engage in AHS to improve academic outcomes including content mastery and performance indicators, like grades (Li et al., 2023). Because students are likely to face academic setbacks in college, it follows that they may seek help to remedy those setbacks. Pressure to succeed imparted by the MMS (Walton & Truong, 2023) is likely to further drive Asian American college students to seek help.

Students who have internalized a hard work stereotype are likely to seek help differently than those who have internalized a stereotype of innate intelligence. Researchers have identified two kinds of help-seeking behaviors (Karabenick & Knapp, 1988; Roussel et al., 2011): instrumental and executive help-seeking. Students who believe that hard work is a pathway to subject mastery were found to be more academically engaged than students who believed they lacked the competence required to be effective (Skinner et al., 2008). Belief that one lacks competence is positively associated with executive help-seeking, and negatively predicts instrumental help-seeking (Roussel et al., 2011). Together, these studies suggest that for students who have internalized a stereotype of hard work, instrumental help-seeking offers a pathway from effort to success. Similarly, for students who have internalized a stereotype of innate intelligence, executive help-seeking exposes incompetence by seeking an answer.

Therefore, it is hypothesized that an internalized stereotype of hard work will predict instrumental help-seeking because instrumental help-seeking implies a person will be motivated to work toward understanding, rather than simply seeking an answer (e.g., “learn to fish”). It is further hypothesized that an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence is predictive of executive help-seeking because a person who believes their intelligence is unlikely to improve as a function of effort is likely to avoid the effort of instrumental help-seeking in favor of seeking an answer instead (e.g., “asking for a fish”).

Help-Seeking as a Mediator of MMS and Self-Esteem

Because the MMS is associated with pressure to succeed (Walton & Truong, 2023), Asian Americans are likely to experience increased self-esteem when they are able to meet the expectations MMS, or a decrease when unable. Self-esteem was chosen as an outcome because it has been found to effect engagement in academic settings (Acosta-Gonzaga, 2023), and is commonly explored as an outcome in studies on relationships, success in school, work, and mental and physical health (Orth & Robins, 2022). Furthermore, instrumental help-seeking is associated with a positive sense of self (e.g., competent, autonomous), whereas executive help-seeking is associated with a negative sense of self (Roussel et al., 2011). These studies suggest that expressions of instrumental and executive help-seeking behaviors will be differentially associated with self-esteem in Asian American college students.

Previous research found that internalization of the MMS is associated with self-esteem. In the Witkow et al. (2024) study, internalization of a stereotype of hard work was positively associated with self-esteem when mediated by a growth mindset. Similarly, internalization of a stereotype of innate intelligence was negatively associated with self-esteem when mediated by a fixed mindset. These different pathways to self-esteem suggest that internalization of the MMS

can be positive when internalized as a stereotype of hard work or negative when internalized as a stereotype of innate intelligence.

Studies show that AHS is similarly associated with mindset, and thus likely to affect self-esteem when the MMS has been internalized. Researchers Cutumisu and Lou (2020) found that a growth mindset was positively associated with seeking instrumental feedback (e.g., how to improve performance), whereas a fixed mindset was positively associated with performance feedback (e.g., whether the work was correct). Instrumental and performance feedback are associated with instrumental and executive help-seeking, respectively (Yang & Stefaniak, 2024). It is expected that Asian American college students who have internalized a stereotype of hard work will see a boost to self-esteem when engaged in instrumental help-seeking. Alternatively, Asian American college students who internalize a stereotype of innate intelligence will see a reduction in self-esteem when engaged in executive help-seeking.

Present Research

Because help-seeking is likely unavoidable in an educational setting (Yang & Stefaniak, 2024), the goal of the current paper is to explore the pathways from the internalization of the MMS subscales to self-esteem (Witkow et al., 2024) as mediated by AHS subscales (Karabenick, 2003). It is hypothesized that an internalized stereotype of hard work in Asian American college students will be positively associated with self-esteem, and that this relationship will be mediated by instrumental help-seeking. Similarly, it is hypothesized that an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence in Asian American college students will be negatively associated with self-esteem, and that this relationship will be mediated by executive help-seeking.

Method

Participants

Participants were 226 self-identified Asian American adults recruited using Prolific Panels during the Spring of 2024 (64.2% female, 30.5% male, 4.9% non-binary, and 0.4% other). The sample was approximately college age, with an average age of 20.8 years ($SD = 1.93$, range $= 18 - 26$). All participants reported being enrolled in college. While all participants identified broadly as "Asian," about four-fifths of the sample (81%) reported being born in the United States, while the rest of the sample (19%) was born outside of the United States.

Procedure

Participants were required to meet several criteria for inclusion in the study. First, participants were required to be currently enrolled in an undergraduate degree program or a technical / community college. To proceed with the survey, participants were required to identify as Asian or Asian American, currently reside in the United States, and be fluent in English. The survey was completed online, and participants were compensated directly through Prolific. Only participants who had a Prolific approval rating above 95 were permitted to take the survey. Additionally, two attention checks were also included; one person failed and was excluded. The study was reviewed and approved by an institutional review board.

Measures

Internalization of the MMS

Internalization of the *hard work* component of the MMS was assessed using a modified version of the M-Achievement subscale of the IM-4 (Yoo et al., 2010, 2015). This 5-item scale included items such as "In comparison to other racial minorities, Asian Americans are harder

workers." The *Innate intelligence* component of the MMS was assessed using the same modified scale. This 6-item scale included such items as "In comparison to other racial minorities, Asian Americans are more academically gifted". Items for both scales were measured using a 5-point scale (1 = *strongly disagree*, 5 = *strongly agree*). These two subscales were strongly correlated ($r = .67$, $p < .001$), and participants tended to indicate higher levels of internalization of a hard work stereotype ($M = 3.42$, $SD = .92$) compared to an innate intelligence stereotype ($M = 2.72$, $SD = .87$), $t(225) = 14.5$, $p < .001$, $d = .96$). Descriptive statistics for all scales are shown in Table 1.

Help seeking

Help seeking behavior was assessed using a 4-item measure adapted from Karabenick (2003). *Instrumental help-seeking* was assessed using two of these items. Both items were highly correlated ($r = .66, p < .001$). Participants rated items such as "If I were having trouble understanding the material in this class, I would ask someone who could help me understand the general idea." *Executive help-seeking* was assessed using the other two items. These items were highly correlated ($r = .70, p < .001$). Participants rated item such as "The purpose of asking somebody for help in this class would be to succeed without having to work as hard." Both measures were rated on a 5-point scale (1 = *strongly disagree*, 5 = *strongly agree*).

Self-Esteem

Self-esteem was assessed using the 10-item Rosenberg Self-Esteem Scale (Rosenberg, 1986). Ten items ($\alpha = .89$) were rated on a 5-point scale (1 = *strongly disagree*, 5 = *strongly agree*), with higher values indicating higher self-esteem. Sample items include "I feel that I have a number of good qualities" and "I take a positive attitude toward myself."

Results

Preliminary Analyses

The primary interest of the present study is to understand the associations between internalization of the MMS, help seeking, and self-esteem. Prior to conducting mediation analyses, several correlation and regression analyses were conducted to first determine whether relationships between internalization of the MMS as a stereotype of hard work versus innate intelligence, help seeking behavior (e.g., instrumental versus executive), and self-esteem existed. A correlation matrix of all used in the study can be found in Table 2. All analyses were conducted using the Jamovi Project open statistical platform, version 2.3.28.0.

Correlation Analysis

Internalization of MMS and Self-esteem. In contrast to what was hypothesized, there were no significant associations between an internalized stereotype of hard work and self-esteem, or between an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence and self-esteem (Table 2).

Self-esteem and help-seeking behavior. As hypothesized, there was a significant positive association between instrumental help seeking and self-esteem ($r = .29, p < .001$). In contrast to what was hypothesized, executive help seeking was not significantly associated with self-esteem (Table 2).

Internalization of the MMS and help seeking. As hypothesized, an internalized stereotype of hard work was associated with instrumental help-seeking ($r = .23, p < .001$) (Table 2). Similarly, an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence was more strongly associated with executive help-seeking ($r = .26, p < .001$) (Table 2). In contrast to what was hypothesized, an internalized stereotype of hard work was associated with executive help-seeking ($r = .13, p <$

.05) (Table 2). Similarly, an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence was more strongly associated with instrumental help-seeking ($r = .14, p < .05$).

Regression Analysis

Self-esteem. A multiple regression analysis was conducted to test whether the two components of help seeking independently predicted self-esteem. When both were examined simultaneously, instrumental help-seeking positively predicted self-esteem, while executive help-seeking negatively predicted self-esteem (Table 3). A second multiple regression analysis was conducted to test whether an internalized stereotype of hard work and innate intelligence independently predicted self-esteem. Neither an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence nor hard work significantly predicted self-esteem (Table 3).

Help seeking. To test whether internalization of the MMS as hard work and innate intelligence had independent effects on help seeking behavior, two multiple regression analyses were conducted. The first test examined the extent to which internalized hard work and internalized innate intelligence would independently predict instrumental help seeking. In this regression, internalized hard work but not internalized innate intelligence was found to significantly predict instrumental help seeking (Table 4). The second test examined the extent to which internalized hard work and internalized innate intelligence would independently predict executive help seeking. In this regression, internalized innate intelligence but not internalized hard work was found to significantly predict executive help seeking (Table 4).

Tests of Indirect Effects of Internalization of Stereotypes on Self-Esteem

To test for indirect effects of internalization of the MMS scales on self-esteem, two separate mediational analyses were conducted. In the first analysis, internalization of a hard work stereotype was the predictor variable and instrumental help-seeking was the mediational

variable. In the second analysis, internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype was the predictor variable and executive help-seeking was the mediational variable.

Indirect Effect of Internalization of a Hard Work Stereotype on Self-Esteem Through Instrumental Help-Seeking

Given that internalization of a hard work stereotype was not associated with executive help-seeking in the preliminary regression analyses, the indirect effect of internalization of a hard work stereotype on self-esteem was only examined through instrumental help-seeking. As can be seen in Table 5 and Figure 1, internalization of a hard work stereotype was positively associated with instrumental help-seeking ($a = .24, p < .001$), and instrumental help-seeking was positively associated with self-esteem ($b = .21, p < .001$). Mediational analysis revealed a significant indirect effect ($ab = .05, p < .021$), indicating that instrumental help-seeking mediated the relationship between an internalized stereotype of hard work and self-esteem.

Indirect Effect of Internalization of an Innate Intelligence Stereotype on Self-Esteem Through Executive Help-Seeking

Given that internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype was not associated with instrumental help-seeking in the preliminary regression analyses, the indirect effect of internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype on self-esteem was only examined through executive help-seeking. As can be seen in Table 6 and Figure 2, internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype was positively associated with executive help-seeking ($a = .32, p < .001$), and instrumental help-seeking was marginally but negatively associated with self-esteem ($b = -.09, p < .10$). Mediational analysis revealed a marginally significant indirect effect ($ab = -.03, p < .094$), indicating that executive help-seeking mediated the relationship between an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence and self-esteem.

Discussion

As hypothesized, we found that internalizing a stereotype of hard work is associated with instrumental help seeking. Similarly, internalizing a stereotype of innate intelligence is associated with executive help-seeking. Research has shown that instrumental help-seeking is associated with increased learning and academic achievement compared to executive help-seeking, which is associated with reduced academic achievement and learning avoidance (Karabenick, 2003; Yang & Stefaniak, 2024). One way to interpret these findings is that internalization of a hard-work stereotype facilitates learning, while internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype facilitates answer seeking.

The Mediational results suggest that internalizing a stereotype of hard work is positively associated with self-esteem when the student engages in instrumental help-seeking. Similarly, internalizing a stereotype of innate intelligence is negatively associated with self-esteem when the student engages in executive help-seeking. This finding is in line with the Roussel et al. (2011) study, which found that instrumental help-seeking and executive help-seeking were associated with positive and negative self-concepts, respectively. It also extends the Witkow et al. (2024) finding that internalization of the MMS is differentially associated with self-esteem when mediated by growth and fixed mindsets. Finally, these findings add to the current literature on internalization of the MMS by demonstrating that internalization of a hard work stereotype versus a stereotype of innate intelligence differentially predicts instrumental and executive help-seeking, the result of which is higher or lower self-esteem.

Limitations and Future Directions

One limitation of this study was that the data came from an existing survey, which limited the number of variables available that were directly related to the current research question. For

example, personality and locus of control could change the nature of the relationship between internalization of the MMS and help-seeking. One study found that trait conscientiousness is highly associated with trait grit (Ponnock et al., 2020). Since instrumental help-seeking is also associated with trait grit (Cutumisu & Lou, 2020), it may be the case that conscientiousness may moderate the relationship between the internalization of the MMS and AHS. Additionally, individuals with an internal locus of control has been found to predict psychological help-seeking (Oladipo & Oyenuga, 2013). It is possible that individuals with an internal locus of control are more likely to engage in instrumental help-seeking, whereas individuals with an external locus of control are more likely to engage in executive help-seeking.

Future studies should also consider examining the associations between internalization of the MMS and help-seeking with different outcome variables. For example, mediational analysis could be conducted to examine whether internalization of a hard work stereotype and semester grades are indirectly related through instrumental help-seeking. Similarly, the relationship between an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence and semester grades may be mediated by executive help-seeking. Research has shown that students who engage in instrumental help-seeking compared to executive help-seeking see an increase in test scores from midterms to finals (Karabenick, 2003). It is expected that internalization of a stereotype of hard work from the MMS will result in higher end of semester grades and an internalized stereotype of innate intelligence will result in lower end of semester grades. Finally, these associations might be explored using frequency of academic resource engagement (i.e. attending professor office hours or engaging with peer tutoring). Researchers have found that students with low self-esteem are more likely to be disengaged in academic settings (Acosta-Gonzaga, 2023). It is expected that

internalization of a stereotype of innate intelligence will result in less academic engagement when mediated by executive help seeking.

Conclusion

By understanding how internalization of the MMS is associated with different AHS behaviors, and the expression of the behaviors is associated with self-esteem, schools can develop pedagogical strategies that facilitate growth of self-esteem. For instance, professors may choose to allow underperforming students to seek help in a manner that reinforces hard work (e.g., opportunities to revisit incorrect answers on test for partial credit) through an AHS pathway (e.g., seeking help from tutoring, classmates, professors). This would provide students an opportunity to engage in seeking instrumental feedback, which is positively associated with both instrumental help-seeking (Yang & Stefaniak, 2024) and a growth mindset (Cutumisu & Lou, 2020). A growth mindset is associated with positive outcomes across multiple domains (e.g., academic, social, goal pursuit; Dweck & Yeager, 2019), including improving academic achievement test scores (Good et al., 2003). Similarly, students who engaged in instrumental help-seeking have shown improved test end of semester test scores compared to midsemester test scores (Karabenick, 2003). Based on the findings of this study, providing students who have internalized a stereotype of innate intelligence a pathway to instrumental help-seeking may in turn promote a growth mindset, and improve self-esteem. Because self-esteem is associated with increased academic engagement (Acosta-Gonzaga, 2023), as well as predictors of wellbeing (e.g., improved relationships, mental and physical health), such a pathway may reduce the negative effects of internalization of the MMS.

Table 1

Descriptive statistics

Variable	*Mean*	*SD*	*α*	Observed range	Possible range
Internalization of HW stereotype	3.42	.92	.92	1-5	1-5
Internalization of II stereotype	2.72	.87	.93	1-5	1-5
Instrumental help-seeking	3.42	.97	.79	1-5	1-5
Executive help-seeking	2.41	1.08	.82	1-5	1-5
Self-esteem	3.14	.72	.89	1-4.9	1-5

Note. HW refers to the internalization of hard work stereotype and II refers to the internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype.

Table 2

Associations Between the Model Minority Stereotype Subscales, Help-Seeking Subscales, and Self-Esteem

Variable	*n*	1	2	3	4	5
1. HW	226	—				
2. II	226	.67***	—			
3. Instrumental HS	226	.23***	.13*	—		
4. Executive HS	225	.14*	.26***	.15*	—	
5. Self-esteem	226	.10	.08	.29***	-.11	—

Note. HW refers to the internalization of hard work stereotype and II refers to the internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype, Instrumental HS refers to instrumental help seeking, and executive HS refers to instrumental help seeking.

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$

Table 3

Associations Between the Model Minority Stereotype Subscales and Instrumental Help Seeking and Executive Help Seeking.

Variable	B	$SE\ B$	β	t
Self-esteem				
Constant	2.60	.19		14.05***
Instrumental Help-seeking	.23	.05	.31	4.79***
Executive Help-seeking	-.10	.04	-.15	-2.36*
R^2				.10
$F(2,222)$				12.9***
Self-esteem				
HW	.06	.07	.08	.91
II	.02	.07	.02	.26
R^2				.01
$F(2,223)$				1.11

Note. HW refers to the internalization of hard work stereotype and II refers to the internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype. $SE =$ standard error.

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$

Table 4

Associations Between the Model Minority Stereotype Subscales and Instrumental Help Seeking and Executive Help Seeking.

Variable	B	$SE\ B$	β	t
Instrumental help seeking				
Constant	2.63	.25		10.56 ***
HW	.26	.10	.25	2.87 **
II	-.04	.10	-.04	-.42
R^2				.05
$F(2,223)$				6.14 **
Executive help seeking				
Constant	1.65	.27		6.01 ***
HW	-.07	.10	-.06	-.65
II	.36	.11	.29	3.38 ***
R^2				.07
$F(2,223)$				8.06 ***

Note. HW refers to the internalization of hard work stereotype and II refers to the internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype. $SE =$ standard error.

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$

Table 5

Test of the Indirect Effect of Internalization of a Hard Work Stereotype on Self-Esteem Through Instrumental Help-Seeking

	Variable	B	$SE\ (B)$	t
M	(instrumental help-seeking)			
	Constant	2.61	.24	10.76 ***
	X (HW)	.24	.07	3.49 ***
	M (instrumental help-seeking)			
	R^2			.05
	$F(1,224)$			12.2 ***
Y	(self-esteem)			
	Constant	2.33	.22	10.72 ***
	X (HW)	.03	.05	.50
	M (instrumental help-seeking)	.21	.05	4.33 ***
	R^2			.09
	$F(2,223)$			10.6 ***

Note. HW refers to the internalization of a hard work stereotype. $SE =$ standard error.

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$

Table 6

Test of the Indirect Effect of Internalization of an Innate Intelligence Stereotype on Self-Esteem Through Executive Help-Seeking

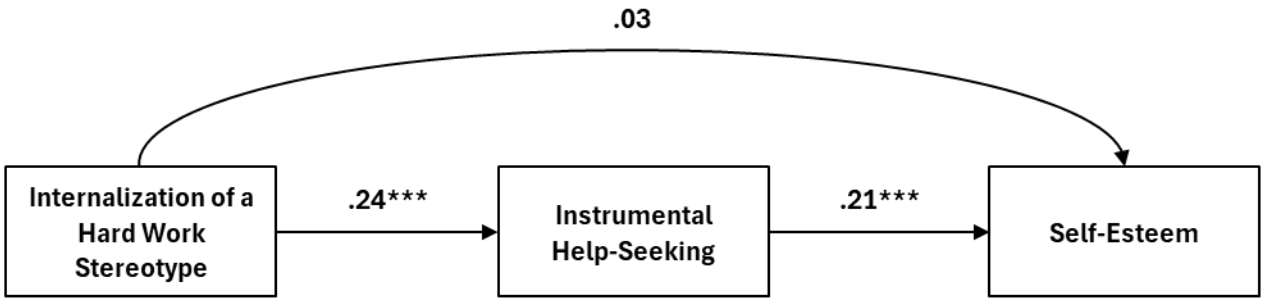
	Variable	B	$SE\ (B)$	t
M	(executive help-seeking)			
	Constant	1.55	.23	6.77 ***
	X (II)	.32	.08	3.95 ***
	M (executive help-seeking)			
	R^2			.07
	F(1,223)			*15.6* ***
Y	(self-esteem)			
	Constant	3.10	.17	18.31 ***
	X (II)	.09	.06	1.62
	M (executive help-seeking)	-.09	.05	-1.97 *
	R^2			.02
	$F(2,222)$			2.61 †

Note. II refers to the internalization of an innate intelligence stereotype. $SE =$ standard error.

† $p < .10$, * $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$

Figure 1

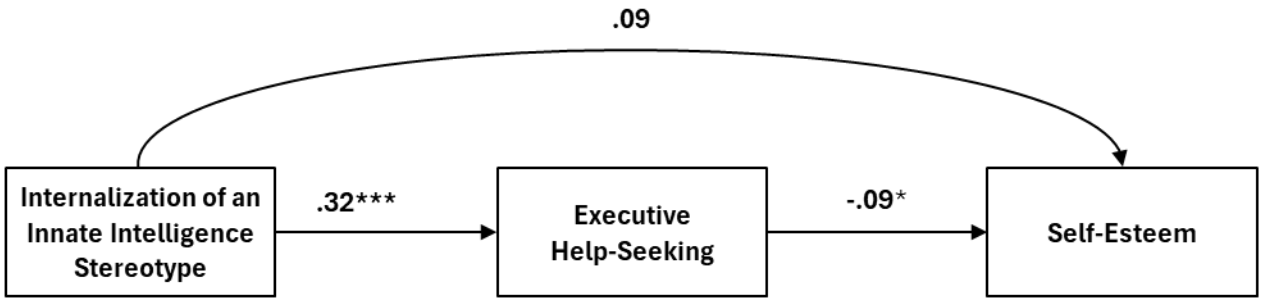
Model Demonstrating the Indirect Effect of Internalization of a Hard Work Stereotype on Self-Esteem Through Instrumental Help-Seeking



Note. Shown are unstandardized regression coefficients.
$*p < .05$. $**p < .01$. $***p < .001$.

Figure 2

Model Demonstrating the Indirect Effect of Internalization of an Innate Intelligence Stereotype on Self-Esteem Through Executive Help-Seeking



Note. Shown are unstandardized regression coefficients.
$*p < .05$. $**p < .01$. $***p < .001$.

References

Acosta-Gonzaga, E. (2023). The effects of self-esteem and academic engagement on university students' performance. *Behavioral Sciences*, *13*(4), 348. https://doi.org/10.3390/bs13040348

Ames, R., & Lau, S. (1982). An attributional analysis of student help-seeking in academic settings. *Journal of Educational Psychology*, *74*(3), 414–423. https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-0663.74.3.414

Cutumisu, M., & Lou, N. M. (2020). The moderating effect of mindset on the relationship between university students' critical feedback-seeking and learning. *Computers in Human Behavior*, *112*, 106445. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2020.106445

Duckworth, A. L., Peterson, C., Matthews, M. D., & Kelly, D. R. (2007). Grit: Perseverance and passion for long-term goals. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, *92*(6), 1087–1101. https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-3514.92.6.1087

Dweck, C. S., & Yeager, D. S. (2019). Mindsets: A view from two eras. *Perspectives on Psychological Science : A Journal of the Association for Psychological Science*, *14*(3), 481–496. https://doi.org/10.1177/1745691618804166

Good, C., Aronson, J., & Inzlicht, M. (2003). Improving adolescents' standardized test performance: An intervention to reduce the effects of stereotype threat. *Journal of Applied Developmental Psychology*, *24*(6), 645–662. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.appdev.2003.09.002

Karabenick, S. (2003). Seeking help in large college classes: A person-centered approach. *Contemporary Educational Psychology*, *28*(1), 37–58. https://doi.org/10.1016/S0361-476X(02)00012-7

Karabenick, S., & Knapp, J. (1988). Help seeking and the need for academic assistance. *Journal of Educational Psychology*, *80*(3), 406–408. https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-0663.80.3.406

Karabenick, S., & Knapp, J. (1991). Relationship of academic help seeking to the use of learning strategies and other instrumental achievement behavior in college students. *Journal of Educational Psychology*, *83*(1), 221–230. https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-0663.83.2.221

Lee, K.-Y., & Joo, S.-H. (2005). The portrayal of Asian Americans in mainstream magazine ads: An update. *Journalism and Mass Communication Quarterly*, *82*(3), 654–671. https://doi.org/10.1177/107769900508200311

Li, R., Che Hassan, N., & Saharuddin, N. (2023). College student's academic help-seeking behavior: A systematic literature review. *Behavioral Sciences (Basel, Switzerland)*, *13*(8), 637. https://doi.org/10.3390/bs13080637

Nelson-Le Gall, S. (1981). Help-seeking: An understudied problem-solving skill in children. *Developmental Review*, *1*(3), 224–246. https://doi.org/10.1016/0273-2297(81)90019-8

Nelson-Le Gall, S. (1985). Help-seeking behavior in learning. *Review of Research in Education*, *12*, 55–90. https://doi.org/10.2307/1167146

Oladipo, S. E., & Oyenuga, T. O. (2013). Psycho-demographic predictors of psychological help-seeking behaviour of undergraduates. *International Journal of Development and Sustainability*, *2*(2), 697–703.

Orth, U., & Robins, R. W. (2022). Is high self-esteem beneficial? Revisiting a classic question. *The American Psychologist*, *77*(1), 5–17. https://doi.org/10.1037/amp0000922

Osajima, K. (2005). Asian Americans as the model minority: An analysis of the popular press image in the 1960s and 1980s. In K. A. Ono (Ed.), *A Companion to Asian American Studies* (1st ed., pp. 215–225). Wiley. https://doi.org/10.1002/9780470996928.ch13

Petersen, W. (1966, January 9). Success story, Japanese-American style. *New York Times*.

Ponnock, A., Muenks, K., Morell, M., Seung Yang, J., Gladstone, J. R., & Wigfield, A. (2020). Grit and conscientiousness: Another jangle fallacy. *Journal of Research in Personality*, *89*, 104021. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jrp.2020.104021

Rosenberg, M. (1986). *Conceiving the self* (Reprint ed.). R.E. Krieger.

Roussel, P., Elliot, A. J., & Feltman, R. (2011). The influence of achievement goals and social goals on help-seeking from peers in an academic context. *Learning and Instruction*, *21*(3), 394–402. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.learninstruc.2010.05.003

Skinner, E., Furrer, C., Marchand, G., & Kindermann, T. (2008). Engagement and disaffection in the classroom: Part of a larger motivational dynamic? *Journal of Educational Psychology*, *100*(4), 765–781. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0012840

Success story of one minority group in U.S. (1966, December 26). *U.S. News and World Report*, 73–78.

Suzuki, B. H. (2002). Revisiting the model minority stereotype: Implications for student affairs practice and higher education. *New Directions for Student Services*, *2002*(97), 21–32. https://doi.org/10.1002/ss.36

Taylor, C. R., & Stern, B. B. (1997). Asian-americans: Television advertising and the "model minority" stereotype. *Journal of Advertising*, *26*(2), 47–61. https://doi.org/10.1080/00913367.1997.10673522

Walton, J., & Truong, M. (2023). A review of the model minority myth: Understanding the social, educational and health impacts. *Ethnic and Racial Studies*, *46*(3), 391–419. https://doi.org/10.1080/01419870.2022.2121170

Witkow, M. R., Thompson, T. L., & Kiang, L. (2024). Unpacking the model minority stereotype: Different pathways to self-esteem through internalized stereotypes of hard work and innate intelligence. *Asian American Journal of Psychology*, *15*(2), 134–145. https://doi.org/10.1037/aap0000335

Yang, F., & Stefaniak, J. (2024). Help-seeking. *EdTechnica*. https://doi.org/10.59668/371.13472

Yoo, H. C., Burrola, K. S., & Steger, M. F. (2010). A preliminary report on a new measure: Internalization of the Model Minority Myth Measure (IM-4) and its psychological correlates among Asian American college students. *Journal of Counseling Psychology*, *57*(1), 114–127. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0017871

Yoo, H. C., Miller, M. J., & Yip, P. (2015). Validation of the internalization of the Model Minority Myth Measure (IM-4) and its link to academic performance and psychological adjustment among Asian American adolescents. *Cultural Diversity and Ethnic Minority Psychology*, *21*(2), 237–246. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0037648